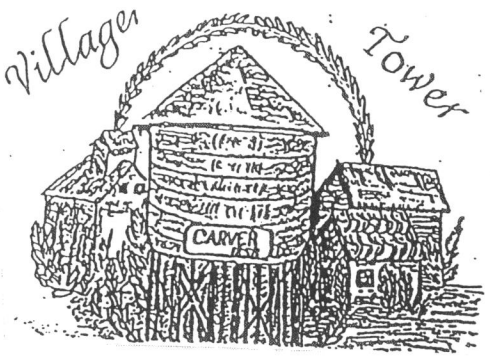
Volume XIX
Number # One Hundred Eighty Two
September/October 2001

# Village Tower






## Terror

Written by: Bonnie Riegert and Ricki Y Schultz

September 11th 2001 is a day that has touched every human being in someway. A day etched into our minds forever! The horror, the terror, the tragedy. Why? Why we ask ourselves over and over again.

Events unfolded on television sets across the world, touching every human being to the core of our souls in disbelief! Was this a wake up call? It was too horrifying to be real... How could this be real? Reality has shoved its way into our psyches unrelentlessly. America is supposed to be a safe haven! What's happened? This feeling of safeness has been now stolen from each and every one of us ruthlessly. This helplessness is worse than a cruel joke.

So many lives forfeited carelessly in a heartbeat leaving us indescribably vulnerable.

How many of us stared into the television sets unable to absorb what we were viewing in our minds. The World Trade Center Towers reduced to rubble. The Pentagon attacked unmercifully. Broken, aching hearts are tormented. Innocent people, volunteers robbed of their existence! This could have happened here, we realize suddenly.

This tragic horror has forced us to look at the world through different eyes. There is the outpour of support for the victims, for strangers, for loved ones, and friends. Our belief in our country's symbol remains steadfast - Our FLAG!

Take a moment to really look at this beautiful flag and a instant to say a prayer for the victims even though they are faceless. The red stripes represent the magnitude of lives lost. The white stripes representing their innocence. The blue patch for the open sky. The stars representative of the stars in the darkness of the night promising a new day. Steadfast is our patriotism, our love and prayers forever in our minds and hearts. May we never forget each and every soul that passed through the gates of heaven on that horrid day leaving behind the lost families, friends and loved ones trying desperately to make sense of the senseless. God bless each and every one of us!



## Municipal Utilities

The council discussed municipal utility connections for residents along the Fourth Street Improvement Project. The possibility of connection fees being put on property taxes was talked about. Letters from owners would be necessary to allow assessments for this to be put on property taxes . A generic letter could be drafted describing this action. An assessment hearing tentatively scheduled for October.

The council was told that presently water usage decreased. The main well was handling current usage without the test well being used. Removal of the water ban was questioned. Keeping it in effect was the consensus of the council. Utilities Superintendent reported that water usage wash higher than last year. The current ordinance needs to be reviewed. Various aspects of the water situation were discussed at length.

The manholes have been washed and vacuumed, but are deteriorating the superintendent told the council. He expressed the need to repair these manholes.

The catch basins that are not operating properly were discussed and the issue was to be addressed by the engineer.

The council then talked about drilling a well and the differences of opinions with the DNR on this issue. Two shallow wells would exceed the cost of one deep well. Comment was also made that a treatment plant may be needed sooner than anticipated. The administrator and the engineer will be scheduling a meeting with the DNR to discuss this issue. Alternatives were also talked about regarding a well site.

## Vegetation Trimming

City personnel crews trimmed trees, bushes and other vegetation at various locations throughout the city. Where trimming was necessary on private property, letters had been forwarded notifying them of the city's intent. One resident was dissatisfied with the extent of the trimming on their parcel. City personnel was of the opinion that their decision was the correct choice considering all the factors involved. Resident requested replacement of vegetation. Replacement was the city's option. Motion was made and carried to consider replacement of vegetation dependent upon reasonable costs.

## Community Park

The Park and Recreation Board requested approval of plan to install new playground equipment at the Community Park. The board obtained bids for new equipment. The present equipment was purchased by the city. The boards' goals are for thirty five thousand dollar improvements over a two year period. Volunteers will be sought for installation of equipment versus hiring a contractor.

Council member voiced concern of the use of pea rock. Eventually this would be replaced by wood chips. Grass and the use of Carver Bluffs fields were discussed. The boards act in an advisory capacity whereas the council has to look at all of the issues. The Park and Recreation Board have committed to a long term park plan. The condition of Carver Bluffs needs to be reviewed by the board further. The playground equipment has been discussed for years. The first priority was this playground equipment. The board is to discuss the other issues further and submit recommendations.

The Park & Recreation Board discussed lights and parking, especially at the Bluff Park area. Question was asked about possible land purchase in the flood plain adjoining the fields in Bluff Park area. The Community Park would be then used as baseball and softball, the Bluff Park strictly for baseball. Statement was voiced that there could be opposition to lights in Carver Bluffs. The board would like a hearing scheduled. The DNR would also have o consent to the plan of park changes. A number of questions would have to be addressed.

If lights ad more parking couldn't be done the issue will not be pursued. These issues should be researched promptly, as the fields need to be reseeded. Discussion occurred regarding meeting with homeowners pertaining to park use.

## Trails

Along with the discussion of the Community Park issues, the mayor voiced his opinion to also look into the status of plans of the trail along Carver Bluffs Parkway.

The Park and Recreation Board also recommended submittal of a letter to Carver County requesting the construction of a trail adjacent to County Road #147 when it is built. The administrator would draft such a letter, as well as approach the Dahlgren Township regarding the issue.

## DownTown Improvement Project

The original schedule for work has not received approval from Carver County nor the state as of yet. The process is more extensive than originally thought. Variances are necessary and it was doubtful that approval would occur much before late fall or early winter. Work started at that point would not be completed prior to snowfall. Administrator explained that the council needs to make a decision whether or not to go ahead without approvals and financial assistance. Going forward at this point could mean increased assessments. The engineer's recommendation was to bid the project this winter and start in spring. This route of action allows more tie for finalization of plans and specifications.

The overall overview of the project was reviewed and discussed. The staff was directed by motion to proceed with efforts to get state and county approval for the prospective project. The council was in favor of the basic plan concept.

## Computer Information System Network Assessment

LSDI representatives were at the council meeting to discuss their report for implementing computer upgrade. Installation and configuring hardware/software, training, etc would be a capitol investment of approximately $20000.00. Some costs could possibly be reduced by purchasing necessary hardware and software through a joint (State) purchasing program which the city participates annually. The administrator is of the opinion that lack of computer upgrading adversely affects staff effectiveness and productivity daily. If LDSI were authorized to proceed, the system could be operable as early as October.

Council member inquired about DVD drives in the computers. There was not and DVD drives included. It was not an item considered. It was the council member's opinion that at least one computer, if not all should be equipped with DVD's. Had plans been considered if computers would be needed during a council meeting at the Church-By-The-River location. This issue had not been considered, but proposal was flexible. Another site would be the Public Works building. Question was asked where the funds were coming from for this computer upgrade. That answer was not available yet. Motion was made and carried authorizing the staff to continue work with LDSI to acquire and install computer network system. Question was asked how the Fire Department's computer fit into this proposal. Present focus is on the city staff. A meeting would have to be scheduled with the Fire Department.

## Church-By-The-River

MN Historical Society grant application for restoration of the Church-By-The-River was talked about by the council. The electrical work is almost complete, heat and air has been completed, municipal utilities connection done and interior plumbing fixtures were installed at the site. Walls are being worked on presently. The bell tower has been cleaned up. The stained glass windows are being repaired.

The MN Historical Society reported that the city could apply for a second grant even though the first grant has not been closed out. A resolution of support is necessary from the council for this final application. Motion was made and carried by roll call vote adopting resolution of support.

## Municipal Utilities Employee

The council reviewed applicants for new utility position. Sixteen applicants applied for the position. The council interviewed two final candidates. Decision was made by motion to hire Scott LaCourse.

## Public Work Superintendent

Ken Frey has expressed his intentions to retire. The council made the decision to promote Paul Schultz if interested and then proceed to post advertisement for Public Works position. The council discussed the issue briefly.

## County State Highway Aid

The city has been asked to support designating County Road #147 as a County State Aid Highway. This action could benefit the city by making state funds available for road improvements. Motion was made and carried by roll call vote adopting resolution supporting the establishment of County State Aid Highway #11.

## Eagle Ridge

Administrator and engineer informed the council that they have been struggling with the issues on the Letter of Credit pertaining to Eagle Ridge. The administrator stated the possibly the best resolution was an agreement with the developer and carry the minor unresolved issues over to the third addition letter of credit. However, it was the attorney's contention that this should not be done in order that these unfinished items get completed. Furthermore, he commented that by not combining them together incites the initiative to resolve outstanding issues on the developers part. The issue could be dealt with at a later date.

## Miscellaneous

The city has been working on violations pertaining to abandoned vehicles within the city. The council discussed their progress, plans and alternatives. The issue would be continued to be worked on.

The council adopted the resolution electing to continue to participate in the local housing incentives account program under the metropolitan livable communities act.

The Chaska High School has requested use of RiverSide Park for a picnic.

## 2002 Budget

The council held a special meeting to discuss the preliminary 2002 budget. Motion was made and carried by roll call vote to adopt resolution accepting the 2002 preliminary budget. The council reviewed the draft of the budget reflecting changes. The council discussed the tax structure changes and time table for approval of the final budget. Question was asked about the Building Inspector's formula for building permits. The council would again review the budget inclusive of additional information obtained.

## SteamBoat Days Committee

The first meeting for 2002 SteamBoat Days celebration is scheduled for January . The also commented that it was difficult getting the parade down 6th Street. Suggestion was submitted that the parade should originate from RiverSide Park next year.

## Drainage Pond

A citizen was at the council meeting inquiring about the work schedule for the drainage pond on their property. The owners had given permission to expand the existing easement on their property. Their own yard work plans have been postponed in the interim of proposed pond work which has not been done yet. They would like to proceed with their own plans. The city administrator explained the situation in the area of the pond. Requesting fund form the WaterShed District to correct the problem has been unsuccessful. Plans to fix the problem are still scheduled to be done, but several issues have to be addressed by the Public Work staff. Homeowners maintenance efforts were recognized.

*Change your thoughts and you change your world.*

*Norman Vincent Peale*

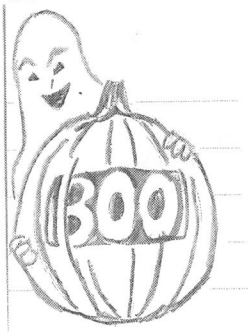


## Fire Department Highlights/Community Calendar



### October 2001

October 1st - Happy Anniversary Paul & Yvonna
Council Meeting
October 3rd - Lions Meeting
October 4th - Heritage Preservation Commission Meeting
- Drill Night
October 7th - Happy Anniversary Kari & Gary
October 8th - Park & Recreation Board Meeting
Columbus Day Observed
October 11th - Happy Birthday Ryan
Happy Anniversary Paul & Gwen
October 12th - Columbus Day
October 14th - National Children's Day
October 15th - Happy Birthday Andrea
Council Meeting
- Drill Night
October 16th - YellowStone Raccoons 4-H Meeting
National Boss Day
October 17th - Lions Meeting
October 18th and 19th - MEA
October 19th - Happy Birthday Annette
October 21st - Happy Birthday Larry
October 24th - United Nations Day
October 25th - Fire Department Meeting Night
October 26th - Happy Birthday Carl
October 27th - LIONS HALLOWEEN PARTY
October 28th - DayLight Savings Ends
October 29th - Happy Anniversary Mom and Dad
October 31st - Halloween




## YellowStone Raccoons

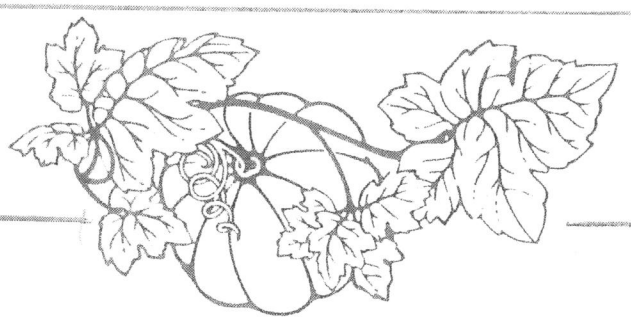
## Carver Softball/Baseball Youth Association

The CSBYA extends gracious thankyou's to everyone for their support and help during SteamBoat Days. To steal a phrase from the local volunteer group, "Lots of people doing a little instead of a few doing a lot". Thank so much!!

The CSBYA would also like to make sure that the Carver Lions are acknowledged for all their support of the program. Thanks Lions!!!

The CSBYA will tentatively be signing up in February. Will keep you posted.

In light of the most recent tragedy to our nation, please, remember to tell those you love just how much they mean to you. Give your kids, mates, spouses, friends, a much deserved hug!



## Carver Lions

Fall is upon us already. Old man winter is just lurking around the corner With fall comes the ghosts, goblins and witches, etc. That means it must be time for the Lions Annual Halloween Party for the young munchkins!

Frankenstein, ghosts, goblins, pumpkins, ghouls and all that goes along with this festive harvest will be setting up shop temporarily in the Village Hall on October 27th from 5PM to 7PM for preschoolers through fifth graders. Don't tell the witches that it really is sponsored by the Lions not the Witches Union!. After seven the Halloween gala has to move out to scare the zageebies out of the older tricksters (teany boppers) or for the munchkins translations your older brothers and sisters, cousins, etc. Everyone has to have fair share time ya' know.

Then have you heard what them there creative Lions have cooked up for the BIG KIDS (adults). Get ready…feel competitive? The Lions are busy setting up rules, regulations, details, fine tuning, and all that good stuff to have a Christmas Light Contest for not only the City of Carver, but also the East Union area. How about that!? Somebody is sure gonna have free time on their hands to go all around and check this scenery out eh? This is for home decorations now! Outside, in case one might think someone will come and visit indoors like Santa….tsk-tsk! Okay, the author is exercising her literary skills here. Ken Frey is the Chairman of this event. Judges haven't been divulged. Prize money will be awarded. All the fine tuning details are being worked on. Details will follow. We are looking at December for this event. Need time to plan in advance so you can win right? The judging will occur in December, as well. Ooooh won't this be fun?

On a more serious note, the Carver Lions would also like to take this time to thank everyone who helped with SteamBoat Days. Without everyone's generosity the event wouldn't happen. SO THANK YOU!!!!

The Lions meet the first and third Wednesday of the month, October through May. Come and see what they are all about. They do lots of fun things. They help the community in so many ways. Thanks to them should also be extended for all they do. New members are always welcomed. Check them out! You won't be sorry.

## Announcement: Turkey Bingo Night

Black Sox Fundraiser -Their Turkey Bingo Night:

When: November 9th
Where: Village Hall
Time: 7 PM - 11 PM

Food and Beverages Available





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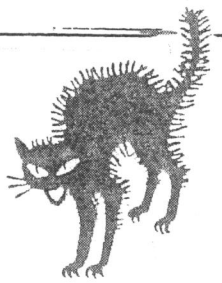
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## *Halloween Party*



*Lions Annual Halloween Party*

*All you preschoolers through 5th Grade be sure to come to the Village Hall on October 27th at 5PM for the Halloween Party scheduled. There will be lots of fun for you.. Personal invitation is extended. Bring mom and dad too. Better leave your brother and sister at home, unless they fall in the age category above. Special fun planned for only your age group.*